Rafael Ibáñez-Corbalán

Engineering Manager

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SUMMARY

Engineering manager with eleven years in software, six of them leading teams. I focus on team health, predictable delivery and growing people. I stay close enough to the code to review designs but I do not try to be the best developer in the room. Away from work I coach a youth basketball team, which keeps my feedback skills sharp. I enjoy mentoring first-time managers.

SKILLS

Team leadership, 1:1s and career growth, Hiring and onboarding, Delivery planning, Technical design review, Incident management, Budgeting, OKRs, Java and Kotlin background

EXPERIENCE

Engineering Manager, Turia Mobility 2020 – Present

- Lead two squads (11 engineers) building ride-booking back-end services.
- Reduced cycle time from 9 days to 4 by limiting work in progress and improving code review habits.
- Hired 8 engineers with a structured, bias-aware interview process.
- Introduced blameless post-incident reviews that cut repeat incidents by a third.
- Run quarterly career conversations and maintain a growth plan for every engineer in my teams. Work with product to protect 20% of capacity for technical debt and reliability work.

Tech Lead, Levante Software Studio 2016 – 2020

- Led a team of five building payment integrations in Java.
- Mentored three junior developers, two of whom became leads.
- Owned estimation and negotiated scope with product.
- Taught two junior engineers to run production incidents and own on-call handovers.
- Reviewed every major design proposal, focusing on clarity and trade-offs.

Software Engineer, Levante Software Studio 2013 – 2016

- Developed Java REST services and batch jobs for retail clients.
- Wrote the first coding guidelines for the studio.
- Participated in on-call rotations and helped stabilise a legacy batch system after a difficult release.
- Learned to estimate and plan releases while building payment integrations for small retailers.

EDUCATION

- MSc Software Engineering, Universidad Politécnica del Turia (fictional) (2011 – 2013)
- BSc Computer Engineering, Universidad Politécnica del Turia (fictional) (2007 – 2011)

LANGUAGES

Spanish (native), English (C1), Catalan (native)